

Speaker 1 [00:00:01] Hi. Thank you again for participating in this interview. We just want to know more about your views on romantic relationships. We believe that your experience and perspective would bring so much to a project. Before we begin, is it fine if I record this interview? We will be using it for transcription and note taking. Is it fine if I record?

Speaker 2 [00:00:24] Okay.

Speaker 1 [00:00:25] Okay. How old are you?

Speaker 2 [00:00:28] [56-60] years old.

Speaker 1 [00:00:31] How long have you been together with your partner?

Speaker 2 [00:00:34] [26-30] years.

Speaker 1 [00:00:35] [26-30] years. Do you have children?

Speaker 2 [00:00:38] Yes, [1-5].

Speaker 1 [00:00:38] For [1-5] children? Yeah. Who lives in the household?

Speaker 2 [00:00:43] All of them.

Speaker 1 [00:00:44] All of them. And you and your partner? Yes. So [6-10].

Speaker 2 [00:00:47] People? Yes.

Speaker 1 [00:00:49] What is your main source of income? What is your job?

Speaker 2 [00:00:52] We have [occupation].

Speaker 1 [00:00:55] [Occupation]?

Speaker 2: Yeah.

Speaker 1: Are you the. Who's the main source of income? Is it, Is it you or is it your partner?

Speaker 2 [00:01:05] My partner.

Speaker 1 [00:01:07] How would you like to address your partner? Is it boyfriend? Partner? Husband? Lover?

Speaker 2 [00:01:15] Partner.

Speaker 1 [00:01:16] Partner? You like partner? Um, tell us a little bit about your love story. How did you guys meet?

[Portion Redacted]

Speaker 1 [00:02:35] Getting engaged? Mm hmm. Um, how. How would you compare the quality of your relationship to the. To the quality of your relationship with your friends? What is the difference?

Speaker 2 [00:02:53] It's different. Of course it's different. It's totally different. And my relationship with my partner is full of love and understanding each other and respect for each other. And very honest. And honesty means honesty and. The most important thing is respect. Respect each other because respect brings love after that. So respect is the most important thing.

Speaker 1 [00:03:36] Why do you think it's more than love?

Speaker 2 [00:03:38] Respect is more than love is more important. Because when you respect each other, we will love each other.

Speaker 1 [00:03:45] How? How does that compare to the, to your friends' relationships?

Speaker 2 [00:03:53] My relationship with my friends is. There is some common with relationship, is love, respect, understanding each other. But the partner is different than the than the friend.

Speaker 1 [00:04:16] Because you spend time together.

Speaker 2 [00:04:17] Because. yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:04:18] Yeah. Your partner that you spend most of the day with him, all of the day with him. And the friend, you meet friend [1-5] hours.

Speaker 1 [00:04:28] Yeah. Hmm can I also ask about how many romantic partners you've had in the past?

Speaker 2 [00:04:38] How many, what it means, how.

Speaker 1 [00:04:40] Romantic partners you've had in the past?

Speaker 2 [00:04:43] No.

Speaker 1 [00:04:45] You don't want to answer this question. Okay. Um.

Speaker 2 [00:04:50] But no, no, no, no. In the past. No, really?

Speaker 1 [00:04:55] Oh, you didn't have any?

Speaker 2 [00:04:56] You didn't.

Speaker 1 [00:04:57] You didn't have any romantic partner in the past? Yeah. Um, for you, what makes a relationship high quality or low quality?

Speaker 2 [00:05:07] My relationship now?

Speaker 1 [00:05:08] Now, what makes it. What do you think makes a relationship high quality or low quality?

Speaker 2 [00:05:14] Um. As I told you before, this love and respect, understanding each other and hmm

Speaker 1 [00:05:32] And. The respect?

Speaker 2 [00:05:37] Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:05:38] So. So low quality relationships. Don't have love? Respect?

Speaker 2 [00:05:45] Yes, of course.

Speaker 1 [00:05:47] Why? Why do you think love and respect are so important?

Speaker 2 [00:05:50] Respect is to be. Respect is most important thing in the relationship. Because when you respect your partner, you mean you love him. You. You appreciate him. You appreciate him. You. Him. You. Become everything in your life. The most important thing in your life.

Speaker 1 [00:06:25] Um. When would you say your relationship was about respect or had respect? Is it early in the relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:06:39] No, not early. Not early. After many years of marriage.

Speaker 1 [00:06:46] So before it was different?

Speaker 2 [00:06:48] Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:06:52] So. For you, what are the most important things in a relationship? Is it. Is it what you said? Love and respect? Yeah. Or is there anything else that you and.

Speaker 2 [00:07:06] Understanding each other, appreciate each other?

Speaker 1 [00:07:11] Communication?

Speaker 2 [00:07:12] Communication. Your partner has to be your friend. Yeah. Your friend. When he becomes your friend, it will be a good relationship, it will be a good relationship.

Speaker 1 [00:07:28] Okay. What? What is your definition of love?

Speaker 2 [00:07:32] Definition of love. Love is. The most beautiful thing in the world. The most beautiful thing in the world. And always love comes suddenly without any arrangement.

Speaker 1 [00:07:52] Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:07:53] No, this is.

Speaker 1 [00:07:55] What does it. What does it mean? What does love mean?

Speaker 2 [00:07:59] You don't arrange to be loved or to love. You don't arrange it. You don't. You don't have a plan to love. The love comes suddenly.

Speaker 1 [00:08:09] If I ask. If I ask about your definition of love, what would you. What would. What would your definition be?

Speaker 2 [00:08:17] Definition is a lovely feeling.

Speaker 1 [00:08:21] It's a feeling.

Speaker 2 [00:08:22] It's a feeling. Of course. It's a lovely feeling.

Speaker 1 [00:08:27] How do you know that you love your partner?

Speaker 2 [00:08:31] Because I. I love my partner. Because I always. Afraid. Not afraid of him. Afraid to him. Afraid to him. Not afraid of him. Afraid to him. I always worried he would be good and be in good health.

Speaker 1 [00:08:55] You're always worried for him.

Speaker 2 [00:08:58] Yes. Yes, of course.

Speaker 1 [00:09:02] How important is love in a relationship? How important? Can there be a relationship without love?

Speaker 2 [00:09:10] If a relationship with out of it will be not a good relationship, It's. It's. It's not good in marriage. If marriage without love, it's not good marriage.

Speaker 1 [00:09:23] So it has to be in a relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:09:25] Yes, of course.

Speaker 1 [00:09:26] How do you know that your partner loves you?

Speaker 2 [00:09:30] Many things. I feel he loves me. I feel that. I feel that in his behavior. In his manners. In his. When he is when he talk to me, when he takes care of me. Many things.

Speaker 1 [00:09:52] So it's the actions? What he does?

Speaker 2 [00:09:55] Yes, of course.

Speaker 1 [00:09:58] What would you say the challenges in your relationship are?

Speaker 2 [00:10:05] What does it mean?

Speaker 1 [00:10:09] Challenges, any difficulties or..

Speaker 2 [00:10:12] Of course, we faced many problems.

Speaker 1 [00:10:14] Problems.

Speaker 2 [00:10:14] And yes, we face during our life, during during our marriage, the years of our marriage, we faced many problems and we tried to solve it.

Speaker 1 [00:10:27] What are what are the problems about like what is the main issue in the relationship or the challenges? Does not need to be super detailed, just in general? Is it about work? Is it about home? Is it about time?

Speaker 2 [00:10:48] Work, home, time, Money. Many things

Speaker 1 [00:10:55] Everything.

Speaker 2 [00:10:58] Kids. Raising kids. Raising kids. Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:11:01] So you. You and your partner

Speaker 2 [00:11:03] The family issues. Family issues.

Speaker 1 [00:11:06] So you guys fight. Are you?

Speaker 2 [00:11:09] In the beginning. We were fighting in the beginning, but. But when we grow up. When we grow up, we become more wisdom and more wise. We become more wise and more calm.

Speaker 1 [00:11:27] How often would you say these fights are? How often do you guys fight?

Speaker 2 [00:11:38] How often? Before we fight too much. Many times in the past, in the beginning of marriage, in the beginning of marriage. And but after many years of marriage, we understand each other. We appreciate each other. So the fighting would be very rare.

Speaker 1 [00:11:59] When you guys fight, how do you how do you resolve the fight? How do you end the fight?

Speaker 2 [00:12:06] I. I was very angry and very upset. And after day after day after day, become calm and become good.

Speaker 1 [00:12:19] So it takes time for it to resolve.

Speaker 2 [00:12:21] Yes, it takes time. Of course it takes time. And need. Need. You need patience. You need patience to solve your problems. You have to be patient and wise and patient and calm. Don't be nervous. Don't be.. very angry.

Speaker 1 [00:12:45] what umm. What are other ways that you maintain your relationship? To have a good relationship other than being patient and calm?

Speaker 2 [00:12:59] Understanding this rather. Understanding each other and appreciate his perception. Perception? I understand his

Speaker 1 [00:13:16] Perspective?

Speaker 2 His perspective. Yeah, I think that's. That's important. Yeah.

Speaker 1 Would you say that the relationship that you're in is good for you?

Speaker 2 [00:13:28] What does it mean?

Speaker 1 [00:13:29] Is it good for you? The relationship you say you're in?

Speaker 2 [00:13:32] Yes. Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:13:33] Why do you say that?

Speaker 2 [00:13:34] Why? Because my partner loves me and always takes care of me. And always stand with me and stand with me too much in everything.

Speaker 1 [00:13:49] Like what?

Speaker 2 [00:13:51] When I was sick. When I was worried. When I was tired.

Speaker 1 [00:14:00] So he supports you?

Speaker 2 [00:14:03] Very often. Too much. Always, Always, always. Support me.

Speaker 1 [00:14:08] That's good.

Speaker 2 [00:14:09] Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:14:11] Did the relationship change you?

Speaker 2 [00:14:14] Of course. Of course.

Speaker 1 How did it change you

Speaker 2 Because when you when you marry. Many years. Year after year after year the the relationship became very strong. Then before. In the beginning of marriage. The relationship is not strong when you have kids and when you're raising kids together, when you face problems together, when you live together. But the relationship will be strong.

Speaker 1 [00:14:53] But how did it change you as a person?

Speaker 2 [00:14:56] Change me too much and become. Become more mature. More mature. More wise.. More patient. Before I. I didn't. I. I don't have this perspective. I don't have this perspective. When I was young. In the first moments.

Speaker 1 [00:15:29] You don't think you were mature before marriage?

Speaker 2 now?

Speaker 1 Before marriage.

Speaker 2 [00:15:35] Before marriage I was mature but now I, I more mature than before.

Speaker 1 [00:15:38] It made you more..

Speaker 2 [00:15:40] More, Of course. More than before. Because I am getting old. I get old. I'm getting older.

Speaker 1 [00:15:49] What about your

Speaker 2 [00:15:49] so of course I changed

Speaker 1 [00:15:50] What about your partner? Did the change during the relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:15:55] Too much. Too much. Changed too much. Yeah, of course.

Speaker 1 [00:15:59] How did he change?

Speaker 2 [00:16:00] He changed better. Better way. Became better. Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:16:04] How so? In what way?

Speaker 2 [00:16:07] Everything in his behavior in his. Speech, in his language, in his behaviors, in his. Many ways.

Speaker 1 [00:16:23] How he talks to you?

Speaker 2 [00:16:25] He always talks to me. He always talked to me.

Speaker 1 [00:16:28] When you say speech, do you mean like how he talks to you?

Speaker 2 [00:16:33] He talks to me. Very calm, very respectful, respectful. And. And speak with love Will speak with mercy. Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:16:49] And that wasn't before?

Speaker 2 [00:16:53] Now is better than before. Before he. He was not patient. He was not hmm. He always rushy he always nervous. He always. But now he became more calm, more mature, more wise than before. Yeah. He changed because he, he, he is getting old. He is getting older. So he changed.

Speaker 1 [00:17:26] Do you feel safe in the relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:17:28] Yes, of course.

Speaker 1 [00:17:30] Why?

Speaker 2 [00:17:33] Because my husband always protects me, he, he he he's protective for me. He protects me from everything. And when I'm afraid. When I'm worried, when I'm. He always takes care of me and talks to me and makes me calm.

Speaker 1 [00:18:09] This is about your partner. If he is responsive, meaning if he responds to your needs. So one is not at all true. And then there is nine, which is very true. So from 1 to 9, I want to ask you, does your partner listen to you?

Speaker 2 [00:18:34] Yes he listens to me.

Speaker 1 [00:18:36] Is it very true or not at all true or somewhat true?

Speaker 2 [00:18:43] Very, very true. Very true. Completely true. Yeah. He always. He always. Listen to me. Always. Yeah.

Speaker 1 So

Speaker 2 He always talks to me. Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:18:57] Would your answer be the same if I were to ask you? Does your partner is your partner responsive to your needs?

Speaker 2 [00:19:05] Yeah, of course.

Speaker 1 [00:19:06] Is it also completely true? Yeah. Why? Is it completely true or not? Sometimes true. Or moderately true.

Speaker 2 [00:19:16] Because he always responds. All my questions, my needs, my requirements.

Speaker 1 [00:19:24] You think he. You think he always listens to you, too, right?

Speaker 2 [00:19:28] Yeah, he always.

Speaker 1 [00:19:29] What are the. Can you provide some examples for that?

Speaker 2 [00:19:35] When I was tired. When I was sick, he always listened to me. And he he always told me, Tell me what? You, what? What happened? What do you? What do you feel? What do. And he always takes care of me. He. He's always worried about me when I was tired. When I was sick, when I was. Takes care of me takes care of me too much.

Speaker 1 [00:20:04] So you feel like it's completely true for both question one and question two?

Speaker 2 Yeah.

Speaker 1 So the next question is going to be a little bit sensitive for you to share. But I also wanted to know more about physical intimacy as a couple. Um. So how often do you have sex with your husband?

Speaker 2 [00:20:37] [laughs] Once a week. Twice a week.

Speaker 1 [00:20:41] How satisfied are you with your sex life?

Speaker 2 [00:20:46] I'm very satisfied.

Speaker 1 [00:20:47] You said you're very satisfied. You're okay. So in general, how satisfied are you with your relationship? Is it completely satisfied? Very dissatisfied. I'm sorry. Is it completely dissatisfied? This dissatisfied? Very dissatisfied. Somewhat dissatisfied. Or is it neutral? Or is it somewhat satisfied? Very satisfied or completely satisfied?

Speaker 2 [00:21:20] Very satisfied.

Speaker 1 [00:21:23] In general, you think you're very satisfied with your partner?

Speaker 2 [00:21:25] Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:21:27] So it's not completely satisfied but it's very satisfied?

Speaker 2 [00:21:30] Because sometimes they have problems and you have negotiation. We have some struggle, some simple struggles. Not everything would be good.

Speaker 1 [00:21:40] So it's not perfect?

Speaker 2 [00:21:42] Perfect. Nobody's perfect. Nobody's perfect. I'm not perfect. He's not perfect. Nobody's perfect.

Speaker 1 [00:21:50] That's that's why he said it's very satisfied and not completely satisfied right?

Speaker 2 [00:21:54] Yes.

Speaker 1 [00:21:59] Um. So do you feel like their relationship fulfilled your expectations? Do you think it was what you expected?

Speaker 2 [00:22:15] Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:22:17] How?

Speaker 2 [00:22:19] Because I love my partner. I respect him and he or he is the same. He's he loves me. He respects me. He takes care of me. He's he's very responsible. He's very responsible. This is the most, the most beautiful thing in his character. And he's very responsible and he always takes care of everybody in the family. So I love him. I appreciate him.

Speaker 1 [00:22:54] Okay. So we are close to wrapping up. I just want to summarize what we talked about so far. So we talked about your love story, [portion redacted].

Speaker 2 [00:23:11] Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:23:12] And then you also talked about the quality of your relationship. And you highlighted the most important things in a relationship. You said, Love, respect. You said understanding each other and communication. Mm hmm. You also said that you feel safe in the relationship.

Speaker 2 [00:23:30] Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:23:31] And you said, Love is the feeling that you get based on what your partner does. Mm hmm. And you think it's very important? A relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:23:40] Mm hmm.

Speaker 1 [00:23:41] And the challenges in the relationship are things like work and home and raising kids.

Speaker 2 Mm hmm.

Speaker 1 All right. And you did say that the relationship changed to both you and your partner.

Speaker 2 [00:23:58] Yes, of course.

Speaker 1 [00:23:59] Is there anything that you would like to add to, add to the interview? Anything that you would like to mention?

Speaker 2 [00:24:08] No, but I want to say the family is the most important thing in our life. The family is. If you have a good family, if you have a good partner, this is the most important thing in life because work and friends and all this you can. Compensate your. Compensate, you can compensate it. But family, this this is the most important thing in life. If you have if you have happiness in your family, this is the most beautiful thing in life.

Speaker 1 [00:24:52] Okay. Thank you so much. Now, before we end, I want to talk to you about how you will handle the data, The Interview. As a research project, we want to be as ethically transparent as possible. And so we want I wanted to know which data sharing option you are most comfortable with. So option one is that the transcript portion portion of the interview, none of which can be identified to you. So the de-identified transcripts can also be read by other researchers. Option two is that the whole transcript can be shared, removed of sensitive and overly identifying details. So it will be anonymous. Although in this option, I want to say that there is very minimal risk that someone who knows you well can piece together the details in the transcript and and narrow down who among their colleagues they believe it is, although again, no sensitive information will be shared. Of the two options, which one are you more comfortable with?

Speaker 2 [00:26:04] Option one.

Speaker 1 [00:26:05] Option one is better for you.

Speaker 2 [00:26:07] Yeah. Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:26:08] Okay. Well, thank you so much again for participating in this study.

Speaker 2 [00:26:12] You're welcome.